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THE DRAMA HEIGHTENED FOLLOWING AN INTELLIGENCE MESSAGE from the Colombo unit of R&AW. It said that two LTTE operatives were reported to be active in Delhi. Kanth was rushed to the capital and arrested two Sri Lankan Tamils—seventy-year-old Kanagasabapathy and his teenage daughter Athirai—from a hotel in Paharganj. They were brought to the CBI headquarters in Delhi's Lodhi Estate and interrogated.

At the age of thirteen, Athirai had joined the LTTE movement. She was taught how to prepare code sheets for clandestine communication, how to make bombs and drive vehicles through forests, and was even trained to fire AK-47 rifles in military camps of the LTTE's shadow squad. And once she was ready, they brainwashed her into agreeing to bite a cyanide capsule if the need arose. Better bite the cyanide than be arrested, was the LTTE's belief. She had successfully made it to the suicide bombers' group in the LTTE, called the Black Tigress. Her siblings were settled in Switzerland.[1]

In her confession, Athirai spoke with pride. She claimed that the LTTE did not tolerate any kind of opposition within its ranks and that the undisputed leader of the organization was Velupillai Prabhakaran. Disclosing the names of the LTTE leaders she had worked with, Athirai confirmed that Pottu Amman headed the intelligence wing and had been directing Sivarasan and Murugan in the Rajiv Gandhi assassination operation.

She recalled that her friend and an LTTE wireless operator had died in 1988 in a fight with the IPKF at the age of twenty-four, followed by her boyfriend's death within a year, again, in a raid by the IPKF. Besides this, countless LTTE soldiers had fallen to IPKF attacks, she added. She talked about how Prabhakaran was 'compelled' to sign the Indo-Sri Lanka Accord and 'how the IPKF, instead of protecting Tamils in Sri Lanka, actually